1 A hidden shortcut

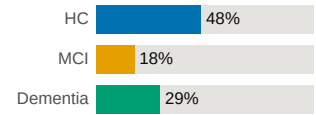
Transcriber style A (illustrative)

`Pat: cat … (2 seconds) … dog`

Transcriber style B (illustrative)

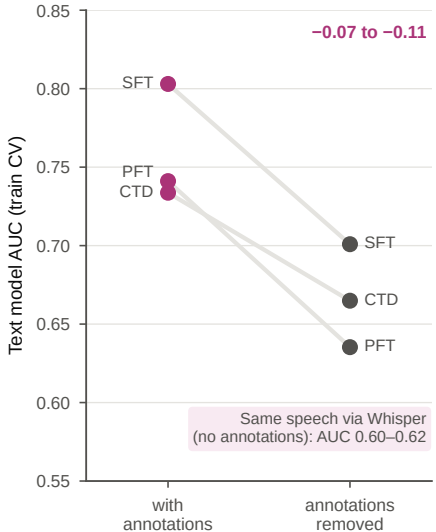
`cat … dog`

Share of files written in style B



Pause notes exist only in style A → they track the transcriber, not only the patient

2 Models exploit it



3 An honest baseline

Audio
speech recording

▼

Whisper + VAD
valid words, pauses

▼

HC norms
age/sex-adjusted z

▼

Logistic model
explainable risk

Test AUC

0.81

[0.70, 0.91]

no human annotation

G ↔ MMSE
ρ = 0.63

Official test set used once (n = 80)